
1643–1704, FRENCH

Charpentier spent most of his life in Paris, where he enjoyed a busy and varied career. The bulk of his large output is devoted to sacred music, which he wrote for churches, convents, and private patrons, notably Marie of Lorraine, Duchess of Guise (known as Mademoiselle de Guise), who was devoted to both religion and music. These works include Masses, psalm settings, and various other types of composition. Charpentier also wrote chamber music and work for the stage, sometimes in collaboration with the great dramatist Molière. His most famous composition today is the majestic, uplifting instrumental prelude to his *Te Deum*. This work was lost until 1953, but the year after its rediscovery the prelude was adopted as the theme music of the European Broadcasting Union, used to precede programs such as the Eurovision Song Contest.

KEY WORKS: Mass for Four Choirs, c. 1670–1675;
The Denial of St. Peter (oratorio) c. 1680–1700;
Andromeda (music for Pierre Corneille's play), 1682; *Te Deum*, c. 1692

Johann Pachelbel